

India witnesses US\$ 1 billion private equity investment in renewable energy

International investors have invested over US\$ 1 billion in India's renewable energy sector. By 2022, India aims to have a generating capacity of 100GW from solar power, 60GW from wind energy and 15GW from other renewable energy sources. This means that over the next seven years, a capacity of around 140GW needs to be added across the country.

As we step into 2016, the road

towards building the renewable energy sector in India looks bright. The government has been quite vocal about the benefits of using renewable energy and the energy it saves for the country. The central government has been encouraging state governments to convince people to use solar energy and we are now witnessing the results of this sustained campaign.

SunEdison to invest US\$ 2 billion in solar energy sector

SunEdison Inc., a US based renewable company, is aiming to make an investment of US\$ 2 billion in a facility that will make polysilicon in India. Polysilicon is used as a feedstock material in many solar energy applications.

According to SunEdison's CEO and president, Ahmad R. Chatila, the company is looking for an Indian partner to make the proposed investment. He has stated, "I am talking to people, but these things take longer

than I would like. It took me two years to negotiate the deal with Samsung in Korea."

The company is also on the look-out for a few locations to set up the unit. This news has come in the wake of the solar and wind energy major facing financial headwinds. They have been forced to sell off their assets globally along with walking away from a proposed takeover of wind energy major Continuum.

Solar tariff dips to ₹ 4.34 per unit

Solar tariffs have dipped further as Fortum India won bids for one of the six projects of 70MW each. The project will be set up in Rajasthan. Fortum did a bidding of ₹ 4.34 per kWh for supplying power to NTPC.

Apart from Fortum, Rays Power Infra and Solar Direct acquired two projects each. NTPC did a reverse bidding for 420MW solar power projects, which will be set up in Bhadla Solar Park II, Rajasthan.

The six bids have come at a tariff that is much cheaper than the earlier lowest price of ₹ 4.63 per kWh, which was proposed by SunEdison and SB Energy. These were for two projects of 500MW and 350MW capacities respectively in Andhra Pradesh. The low bidding had definitely raised concerns regarding its prudence. However, it had elevated hopes for solar energy becoming a good alternative to thermal power minus subsidies.

On the Move

Appointments at Wipro

Wipro Ltd has announced the appointment of T.K. Kurien as executive vice chairman and Abidali Z. Neemuchwala as chief executive officer and member of the board of the company. Both appointments are effective from February 1, 2016.

Asim Warsi will head Samsung's online division

Asim Warsi, VP for mobiles and information technology, will be heading Samsung's online division. He will be responsible for the marketing and sales of all products, including consumer electronics.

ASUS appoints Vinay Shetty as regional director for India, South Asia

Vinay Shetty has been promoted to the post of regional director for India and South Asia for ASUS's computer components and peripheral business. He will be replacing Levis Su, who has moved into the role of director for motherboards, ASUS Computers, China.

IAMAI appoints Kunal Shah as chairman

Mobile Internet body IAMAI has appointed FreeCharge co-founder and CEO Kunal Shah as chairman. Established in 2004, IAMAI comprises mobile content and services, online publishing, mobile and online advertising, e-commerce and digital payments players, among others.

Binny Bansal to take over as Flipkart CEO

Flipkart co-founder Sachin Bansal, who has been CEO since inception, will now take on the newly-created role of executive chairman, while his less-prominent co-founder Binny Bansal, who has been COO, will be CEO. The Bansals are unrelated, were at IIT Delhi around the same time and briefly worked together at Amazon before founding the e-commerce firm.